Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours red comes first; in the main arc of the rainbow you find it on the outer edge next to orange. In the rainbow map of chakras it is the first one and belongs to the root chakra. You can imagine it as a place for **safety**, **support** and the feeling of **“I have my place”**.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

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Muladhara, the root chakra

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The root chakra is called **Muladhara** (mula means root, adhara support). It is traditionally placed at the **base of the spine** and the pelvic floor. It is associated with the element earth, the sound syllable **LAM** and a red lotus with four petals.

Its theme is **safety**, **home**, **the body** and the feeling of **"I am allowed to be here"**. For women this is often translated into questions. Do I have something to lean on? Can I rest? Do I allow myself to say no? Can I leave something to others too? If chakras mean nothing to you, take it as an image of a firm foundation. **Something you stand on, even when you cannot see it.**

When the chakra is open. In your body you feel **at home**, you know what you need, you can rest and **say no** without writing a three-page explanation. Support is not the same as control. **The roots hold, the branches move.**

When the chakra is closed. Traditional descriptions mention **insecurity**, tiredness and fear about basic things. Housing, money, loved ones or the future. It is hard to say no and even harder to rest. **A closed chakra does not mean a bad one.** Sometimes you are simply going through a period when you have little support.

How to add red when you lack support

- **Wear it**
  Red is often recommended on the lower half of the body. Socks, shoes, trousers or underwear. Nobody needs to see it. It is enough that you know.
- **Put it in your home**
  A red seat cushion, blanket or candle. Rather a small detail than a red room from floor to ceiling.
- **Eat it**
  Beetroot, red lentils, strawberries or pomegranate. In yoga texts this is symbolism, not a diet prescribed by a chakra.
- **Get creating**
  Big red strokes, even with your whole arm. With no goal and no question about whether it is "pretty".
- **Head out into nature**
  Walking barefoot, sitting on a stone, leaning against a tree. The main theme is the same. Feeling the ground under your feet.
- **Put it into your day**
  A red bookmark, a candle or a lipstick that you put on just for yourself. A little certainty on an ordinary day.

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When and how to take red away when there is too much certainty

When you are restless, upset or constantly on alert, another strong red **may not be what you long for**. Some descriptions speak of an “overloaded” root chakra, where the need for certainty takes up almost the whole table. This is only a symbolic image. A feeling of insecurity often has to do with what is **really happening**, such as losing a job, a break-up or long-term strain. Then **real support** matters more than a label.

- **Brick instead of sharp**
  Brick, rusty or brownish red tends to be calmer than a sharp one.
- **Further from the face**
  Move red to your socks, say, instead of a scarf.
- **Add brown**
  Brown, ochre, beige, wood, stone or plants.
- **A calmer evening**
  Take away strong red surfaces, choose calmer light, slow your breath or spend a while in nature.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

You start with red, but you need to add green. You can give it the meaning of closeness that you also want to feel alongside your own support. You add blue. Perhaps you want to allow yourself to say what you need so that you feel safe.

You choose the meaning; the colour you add does not diagnose your state.

You do not have to pick just one side of yourself. You may need safety, closeness and courage all at once. In a painting there can be room for all of them side by side, and they need not form a tidy rainbow.

Next to red, other colours can feel calmer or sharper. Green softens it, blue cools it and yellow brightens it. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add red because you lack support and the drive to go for it? Or do you take it away because your body is already humming enough? **You choose the meaning.** Both options can be fine.

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